

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

CFO-ORC FILE # _____

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD _____

Species: Prairie Warbler (*Dendroica discolor*)*Rcd 12/25/00 wpe***Date:** 8 June 2000**Number seen:** one**Sex:** male**Plumage:** Alternate**Locality:** Two Buttes SWA**Elevation:** about 4200'**Nearest town:** Two Buttes**County:** Baca**Time observed:** about 06:10 MDT**Duration of observation:** about 5 minutes

Description: Dave Leatherman had found a singing Prairie Warbler at Two Buttes on 6 June which I chased two days later. I first heard it singing shortly after my arrival in the wooded area immediately below the dam. I eventually saw it quite well looking down on it from the road just downstream from the downhill curve in the road as it patrolled and sang in that area.

The bird was a small warbler that was generally green above and yellow below. The head was pale green with broad yellow supercilia and lower eye arcs and a yellow throat. It had a black eyeline connected at the anterior end to a black moustachial stripe. The eyes were dark and the bill was black. The green back had vague rusty streaks. The yellow sides had thick, black streaks that originated at the "shoulder" and continued onto the greenish flanks. The vent was white. The wings and tail were darker than the back, but still greenish. I did not note the leg color.

Similar species eliminated by description: An Alternate-plumaged male Prairie is almost unmistakable, with the only similar species being Magnolia, Townsend's, and Pine warblers. All of these are easily eliminated by this bird's head pattern, back pattern, and song.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): I heard the bird sing >15 times, giving the typical Type A song – a series of buzzy trills rising in pitch from beginning to end.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen in excess of 200 Prairie Warblers, including conducting a project on the species in GA in 1993. I have also seen 100s of each of the similar species mentioned above.

Light conditions: sun to my left**Optical equipment used:** Zeiss 7x42**Distance, and how estimated:** estimated closest distance at 18 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: none

Other observers who saw the bird independently: Dave Leatherman

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Tony Leukering", with a stylized flourish at the end.

Address: Colorado Bird Observatory, 13401 Picadilly Road, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: This report was written on 24 December 2000 from notes written during the observation.